



Autonomous cargo drones

Elroy Air has raised \$40mIn for demonstrating its first autonomous cargo drone. <https://digit.in/sep21-01>



SpaceX is buying swarm tech

SpaceX has acquired Swarm Technologies, a startup that builds small IoT satellites. <https://digit.in/sep21-02>

Space Robots

These are the droids accompanying humans on iffy space missions where things can go very wrong if the relationship between man and machine breaks down

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HAL 9000

2001 A Space Odyssey

1968

At the heart of what is wrong with HAL 9000 is that machines are not infallible because the algorithms are written by humans. This intelligence that is embedded within the ship cannot resolve a conflict in programming, and decides to make everything simpler by removing humans from the equation. This results in an astronaut on a disaster-stricken mission removing modules from a functional computer, devolving it to a primordial state. Hal 9000 lives a long life (hey, just turn it off and turn it back on) and has an interesting future in the books.

Marvin the Paranoid Android

The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy

1978

Marvin is a robot that is almost tortured into existence, developed by a robotics megacorporation on the quest for creating more human-like artificial intelligence. Marvin is a thoroughly depressed robot undergoing a perpetual existence crisis, and causes cops to commit suicide by just plugging into their systems. Despite many attempts at self destruction, Marvin gets continuously replaced and upgraded, and manages to endure a long life several times in excess of the total age of the universe, because of the wonders of time travel.

